

policyholders to seek cashless treatment at any hospital, the facility might be available only in a few non-network hospitals or nursing homes. This situation is more common in Tier II and III cities.

Network hospitals have ties with health insurers and offer cashless claims facilities, while non-network hospitals may or may not. Instead, policyholders are required to make reimbursement claims with their insurer.

“Expanding the cashless facility to include all hospitals, especially in rural and/or remote areas will require significant administrative effort and investment,” says Colonel Sanjeev Govila (Retd), a Certified Financial Planner and CEO of financial planning and investment company Hum Fauji Initiatives.

Govila adds that managing a seamless cashless system requires robust operational frameworks and constant monitoring to prevent abuse and ensure efficiency.

In an emergency, Jha had to settle the bill himself and then claim reimbursement later. Under the ‘Cashless Everywhere’ initiative, Jha could have been treated at any hospital, and a cashless facility would have been available even if such a hospital wasn’t in the insurer’s network.

Dinesh Khare, a 38-year-old teacher at a primary school, has a similar story. He met with an accident in Varanasi and was admitted to a nursing home for emergency treatment, but could not avail of the cashless claim facility as he failed to inform the insurer within 48 hours.

To get a cashless treatment, a customer should inform the health insurer within 48 hours of admission for emergency treatment. Experts say that needs to be increased to about 72 hours.

Reports suggest around 49% of

BENEFITS OF CASHLESS TREATMENT FACILITY



Increased transparency in healthcare costs

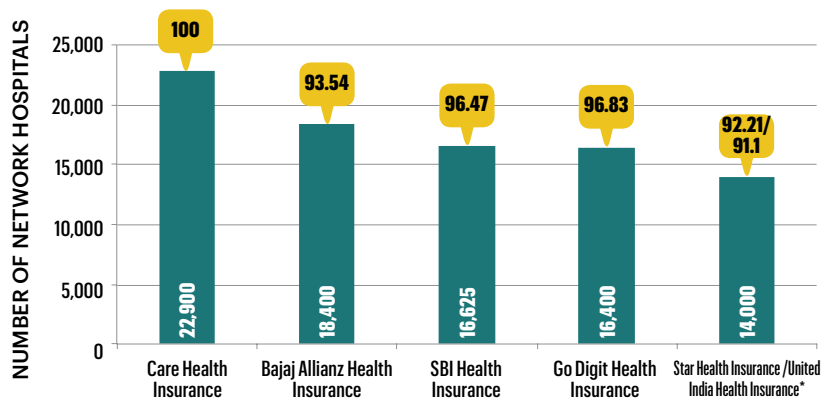
Reduced administrative burden for hospitals

Improved cash flow for hospitals

Faster access to treatment for patients

TOP BRASS

● Out of the 40,000+ hospitals, Care Health Insurance boasts the biggest network of hospitals at 22,900 ● Except Care Health Insurance, none of the insurers has achieved 100% claim settlement ratio (claims paid within three months)



NOTE FIGURES IN BUBBLES REPRESENT CLAIM SETTLEMENT RATIO IN 2022-23; *STAR HEALTH INSURANCE AND UNITED INDIA HEALTH INSURANCE HAVE THE SAME COUNT OF NETWORK HOSPITALS; DATA IS FOR JUST A SMALL SAMPLE OF HEALTH INSURERS **SOURCE** POLICYBAZAAR.COM